

Scheduling, diarising and committing to regular time for exercise and eating well are vital for Workers to ensure they can continue working in the future.

Real-Life Examples

My husband, Tony, you might remember, is a Worker Money Type, and because I know him so well I'm going to use him again as an example here. Tony's level of comfort is around the amount of cash he has in the bank. If it falls below a certain amount, he's prone to overwork until that buffer is restored so keeping an eye on that cash buffer is now a regular habit for him.

Before we met, Tony didn't have bills or other regular expenses set up for autopayment. Like a typical Worker, he was concentrating on working. The first thing I did was organise to get his tax returns up to date and set him up with a regular monthly payment to the Australian Tax Office for his quarterly business activity statements. Sure, he doesn't receive any interest on these early payments, but this set-up means he's not paying any late fees or interest from forgetting to pay. Like many Workers he prefers not paying for help, so we've organised direct debits where possible for all his bills and I have my assistant pay any personal or business bills I happen to find that he's missed.

Because Tony is busy and doesn't enjoy planning, he is prone to unconscious daily spending. He will mindlessly grab things when shopping so we sometimes end up with four bottles of olive oil, eight tubs of yoghurt or an overabundance of avocados, chillies or paper towels. To circumvent this now, he takes time to plan recipes for the week, works out what we have at home, makes a list and then shops on a Saturday morning. While Tony doesn't usually enjoy planning, he has discovered he finds this process of scheduling, organising and cooking food for the week relaxes him and also keeps his Worker Money Type happy because he's still busy doing something.

Tony, like many Workers, values stability and seeing the fruits of his hard work in something tangible. When we met, we created a plan to buy our own home and pay off the mortgage as quickly as possible, which was